

Features at a Glance		
	Adobe GoLive 6.0	Macromedia Dreamweaver MX
User interface	Different from other Adobe products; you might take some time to adjust to it	High customisability with new panel management features and faster access to important features
Ease of use	Smart Objects makes integration and working with media assets quicker	Nifty additions like the Snippets Panel and Code Hints make working much easier
Help/documentation	Decent set of help files is provided but Adobe should have added context-sensitive help	An elaborate and well-indexed set of help files provides relevant information at the click of a mouse
Server-side support	ASP, JSP, PHP and SMIL	ColdFusion, ASP, ASP.NET, JSP and PHP
Support functions & compatibility	Well-integrated support functions	Streamlined, unobtrusive and robust support functions
Integration with other tools	Supports most Adobe design products, Macromedia Flash, Apple QuickTime	Supports Macromedia products
Basic HTML handling	Creation of Web pages is easy, but error-prone*	Creates Web pages quickly, with clean code and without errors
Memory consumption	72 MB	31 MB
Start-up time	38 seconds	17.5 seconds
Price	\$399 (Approx Rs 20,000)	\$399 (Approx Rs 20,000)
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Overall rating	B	A

* A Web page consisting of text, images, tables and rollover effects was created using both software. Once the page was created, we saved the document on the desktop and opened it using Internet Explorer 6.0. The page created in Dreamweaver opened up directly, however, the page created in GoLive did not show any images. There was a problem as GoLive used relative links from where it expected the file to be saved— GoLive's working folder, instead of the desktop.

directly launch and edit Macromedia Flash files and also edit ActionScript. With support for Macromedia Fireworks you can now edit and optimise image assets directly. GoLive works seamlessly with Adobe applications like Photoshop, LiveMotion, and Illustrator along with other applications like Apple QuickTime and Macromedia Flash (GoLive even has a huge set of sample ActionScript). Files saved in Illustrator and Photoshop can be directly edited in GoLive. For example, a sliced PSD source file can be freely resized within GoLive 6.0 without having to leave the application.

Unlike Dreamweaver MX, Adobe GoLive also has an SMIL editor (Synchronized Multimedia Integration Language, which is used to create animations that run directly within your HTML page without the need of a plug-in) with an authoring preview module that allows visual layout and control of an SMIL timeline and embedded assets.

Today you would expect products from the same company to have a certain level of integration and cross functionality. Dreamweaver does support all Macromedia products, but GoLive 6.0 comes up trump here purely because it includes support for third party tools such as Macromedia Flash and Apple QuickTime.

Support functions and compatibility

An HTML editor must be supplemented with powerful CSS handling capability, integrated spell checking, syntax checking and also an extensive tag library. These make authoring tasks a lot easier as the developer can concentrate on building Web sites rather than checking for errors.

The spell checking capability of both software is equally good. Dreamweaver MX and Adobe GoLive both feature a powerful 'find and replace' function wherein you can locate text, source code and specific tags in a particular file, folder or an entire site. The formatting capabilities of Dreamweaver MX and GoLive are also at par. We did not encounter any compatibility issues with either Dreamweaver or GoLive while creating pages for older Web browsers. All in all there's very little to choose between Dreamweaver and GoLive when it comes to support tools and compatibility issues.

Help and documentation

Dreamweaver MX has a huge set of help files, which explain each and every feature in utmost detail. More importantly, it's very well indexed so you can easily find information on a particular task. There's also the new 'Answers' panel, which gives you one-click access to tutorials and online help. Clicking on the 'update' button will automatically download the latest help and

troubleshooting content! Adobe GoLive has a decent set of help files, however, it is not context sensitive or as detailed as the help in Dreamweaver.

And the winner is...

Adobe has infused some noticeable improvements in GoLive 6.0 and engineered a much better product than its previous versions. Its HTML editing tools and solid integration with other design applications makes GoLive pretty accessible and powerful enough to build even the most complex sites. However, in comparison with Dreamweaver MX it is still some way behind. Dreamweaver offers Web authors an excellent and highly customisable interface that makes coding and designing more easy, support for the latest scripting languages and extensive help that provides you with the latest information all the time. With the price of both products being identical there's little doubt as to why Macromedia Dreamweaver MX retains its title as the most powerful Web design tool in the market.



Dreamweaver MX:
Robust features and smart integration